



The Comrie Pipe Band is currently on visit to the area from its base in Scotland. Local residents will get a chance to hear the band perform when it takes on the role of duty band at Sunday's annual Sunset Tattoo here.

Former reeve is Senior of the Year

By Debora Dekok
Gazette Reporter

At Ramsay Township's council meeting last week, Margaret Duncan was honoured with the Senior of the Year award for her contributions to the community.

"We wish Margaret all the best," said Ramsay Reeve Jim Lowry.

Although Duncan has volunteered a lot in the community, she insists she is the one who has benefited.

"What a privilege it is to serve people. And what a wonderful thing it is to serve as a volunteer."

Presently, she is a volunteer on the Carleton Place and District Memorial Hospital's board of

directors representing Ramsay township, and for Clayton Seniors Housing.

"I have loved to work at the hospital on your behalf," Duncan told the township's legislators.

Duncan was Ramsay Township's first female councillor, deputy-reeve, reeve, and Lanark County Warden.

"My family was always interested in politics, so I developed an interest. When my own children were grown and leading their own lives, I became interested in the municipal affairs of Ramsay Township and of Lanark County."

First running for councillor in 1974, Duncan served in municipal

politics for 20 years, never losing an election.

She resigned in 1994 to devote her time to caring for her ill husband Hugh, who passed away in May 1995.

Since then she has spent her time volunteering for various organizations.

"As a volunteer you have the privilege of knowing what's going on in your community," Duncan said when presented with the award July 8.

"I encourage all to volunteer. It fills up your life and makes it interesting."

Local sea cadets to visit Britain

Five Lanark County sea cadets will be flying to England this summer for a two-week, all expenses paid adventure.

Chris Buker and Neil Harper of Perth, Kathleen Hall of Middleville, and Jason Naugler and Mike Simmons of Carleton Place, are part of a month-long exchange program with five sea-cadets from Bristol, England.

The British cadets arrive here July 29 for two weeks of sightseeing and socializing with their Canadian counterparts. They will be billeted with cadet families in the area. Aug. 11 they return to England with their five new Canadian friends for another two weeks of fun.

The Canadian cadets range in age from 15 to 18, and belong to a popular Royal Canadian Sea Cadet Corps based in Carleton

Place.

Exchange coordinator, Hugh Roney, says the Navy League will cover the flight costs for the Canadian cadets, and all touring and sightseeing expenses for both Canadian and British cadets for the two weeks that they are here.

However, the British teenagers must raise the funds for their own airfare.

Whilst overseas, the Lanark cadets will be hosted by a corps from the Bristol suburb, Filton.

At 15, Mike Simmons is the youngest of the Canadian exchange group.

"I'm really looking forward to a lot of fun and learning some different customs, too," he said.

Simmons joined the Lanark corps two years ago at a friend's suggestion.

"It's cool. You go on trips, and you learn what it's like to be in the military."

Lately, the Carleton Place teen has been busy spreading topsoil and moving rocks to earn personal spending money for his upcoming vacation.

There is no chance the exchange group will be bored! While in Canada, some highlights include a special tour of Parliament and Rideau Hall, Toronto's CN Tower and science centre, Old Fort Henry, the Thousand Islands, Niagara Falls, Old Montreal, the Laurentians and Upper Canada Village. There will also be barbecues, swimming, water skiing, and time for shopping and hanging out.

In Britain, the cadets will visit Big Ben, Westminster Abbey, Buckingham Palace, Windsor Castle, then travel to Wales for a coal mine tour, ancient baths and caves at Bath, as well as a submarine

museum and many other points of interest.

Roney said that, with luck and hard work, the exchange may run again next year.

"Six British cadets have already paid their plane fare deposit for 1998," he said.

"Now we have to find the money so that six of our cadets can take part in the exchange as well."

He said the Navy League cannot afford to pay airfares for next year, so the money must be raised through donations.

The RCSC Corps No. 211 Lanark has been operating in Carleton Place for the past 30 years. Membership fluctuates, but presently there are 40 cadets enrolled from across the country. For further information about this youth group, call 257-7951.

Amnesty group highlights plight of refugees

Members of Amnesty International from across Lanark County are taking part in a global campaign to promote and protect the fundamental human rights of refugees around the world.

On Saturday, July 5, AI Group 146 - Lanark hosted an information table and display at the Perth Farmers' Market, one of a series of public awareness events planned by group members.

The year-long Amnesty International campaign calls for enhanced refugee protection in response to a deepening human rights crisis.

"With more than 25 million displaced people worldwide, the need for safe havens has never been greater," said Sue Donaldson, the campaign coordinator for AI Group 146-Lanark. "Innocent lives are endangered when countries close their doors to legitimate refugees."

The centrepiece of the farmers' market display was a 'brick wall', representing the barriers facing asylum-seekers in Canada. Each of the 'bricks' is a pre-printed postcard addressed to a Canadian government official, outlining refugee issues and concerns. Visitors to the display were invited to

help dismantle the barriers to refuge, by removing and signing one of the postcards.

The Canadian Section of Amnesty International recently submitted 10 key recommendations on refugee policy to the Minister of Citizenship and Immigration.

The local focus of the campaign is on public awareness and community involvement.

Group 146 activities so far have included donating literature on the international refugee situation to area schools and libraries. Members of the human

rights group believe that many of the solutions to this global crisis begin with local action.

"Canada has a well-deserved reputation as a compassionate and welcoming nation," Donaldson noted. "We're encouraging Canadian authorities and other governments around the world to improve refugee determination procedures everywhere."

For more information about the refugee campaign or the other activities of AI Group 146, contact Sue Donaldson at 269-3485 or Stephen Cotnam at 256-2785.

Interval House re-opens at its new location

By Theresa Fritz
Special to The Gazette

A month after Lanark County Interval House was badly damaged by a lightning strike during a severe thunderstorm, the women's shelter has re-opened at a new location in Carleton Place.

The lightning strike caused a fire in the roof and attic while the second storey of the house sustained smoke and water damage. The main floor sustained only water damage.

At the time of the incident, 13 people were inside. All of them, along with a few small pets, were safely evacuated.

Insurance is covering the damage caused by the lightning strike and repairs and renovations are expected to take between three and four months. As a result, the new temporary location has been established.

The temporary shelter provides secure accommodation for women and children as well as food preparation areas, laundry facilities, a fenced in playground. Also available on site is counselling, children's support, free emergency transportation, referrals, advocacy, and a 24-hour crisis and support line. People are urged to call 257-5960 or 1-800-267-7946, anytime.

Interval House's business line can be reached by calling 257-3469 while the community support/advocacy and public education line can be reached by dialing 253-3336.

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parameters.

Meanwhile, there appears to be some concern as to just what expenses the province will cover during this process. Almonte Mayor Dorothy Finner wrote to Lanark-Renfrew MPP Leo Jordan June 17 on behalf of the Transition Committee. She notes that city staffs would take care of all the planning groundwork for larger centres. In small, rural municipalities, however, staff and municipal councillors must take on the job together.

"What the province has done is increase our responsibilities a hundred fold and actually do what we were elected to do and plan and prepare policy for a new municipality," she wrote. "I do not think we are being unreasonable to expect remuneration and fees for necessary consultants. You can be assured that our finances are very limited, our staff is minimal and the councillors are giving enormous amounts of time to the process."

The province has set aside \$217 million to assist amalgamating municipalities through the transition period. No specifics as to what qualifies for funding have been released.



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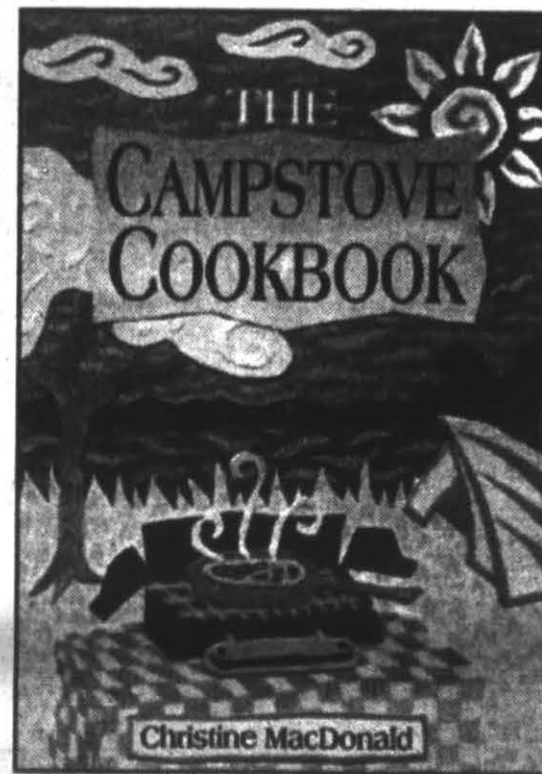
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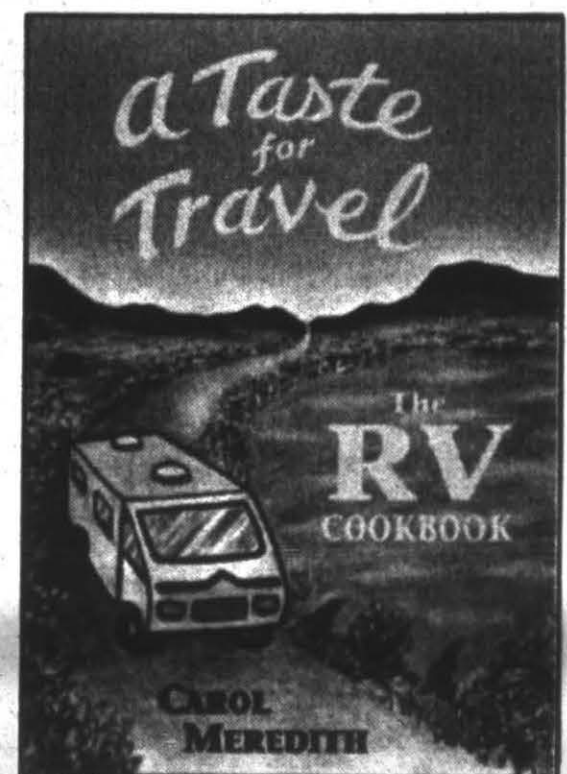
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